

Q1. Illustrate the Etiquettes Between Spouses.

Islam gives great importance to **proper etiquettes between husband and wife** in order to build a peaceful and successful family. Marriage in Islam is based on **love, mercy, trust, and mutual respect**. Allah says:

وَعَايِشُوا فِيهِنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ

“*And live with them honorably.*” (Qur’an 4:19)

Both spouses have **common rights**, such as honesty, loyalty, love, mercy, and good manners. They should speak kindly to each other, avoid harsh words, and show patience. The Prophet ﷺ said:

خَيْرُكُمْ خَيْرُكُمْ لِأَهْلِهِ

“*The best of you are the best to their families.*” (Tirmidhi)

The **husband’s responsibilities** include providing food, clothing, and shelter, teaching his wife basic religious knowledge, and protecting her dignity. He must not expose her private matters or harm her emotionally or physically. The Prophet ﷺ instructed husbands to treat their wives gently (Abu Dawud).

The **wife’s responsibilities** include obeying her husband in matters that do not involve disobedience to Allah, protecting his honor, wealth, and children, and maintaining modest behavior. Allah says:

الرِّجَالُ قَوَّامُونَ عَلَى النِّسَاءِ

“*Men are protectors and maintainers of women.*” (Qur’an 4:34)

Islam encourages mutual cooperation rather than domination. When spouses follow Islamic etiquettes, their marriage becomes a source of peace, mercy, and reward from Allah.

Q2. “O Allah’s Messenger, is there any responsibility that I have to fulfill towards my parents after they have passed away?” — Explain the four matters mentioned in the Hadith.

Islam teaches that **duties toward parents do not end after their death**. A man once asked the Prophet ﷺ about this, and the Prophet ﷺ mentioned **four responsibilities** that remain after parents pass away.

First, making du‘a and seeking forgiveness for them. A child’s sincere prayer benefits deceased parents. Allah loves those who pray for their parents.

Second, fulfilling their promises and pledges. If parents made vows or commitments, the child should try to fulfill them.

Third, honoring their friends. Showing kindness and respect to parents’ close friends is considered part of good conduct.

Fourth, maintaining family ties that exist through parents, such as relatives from the father’s or mother’s side. Breaking family ties is strongly discouraged in Islam.

This Hadith is reported in **Musnad Ahmad** and highlights the depth of Islamic teachings regarding gratitude and loyalty. Allah commands kindness to parents repeatedly in the Qur’an (Qur’an 17:23).

By fulfilling these duties, a child continues to earn reward even after the parents’ death and shows true gratitude for their sacrifices.

Q3. Write down the Etiquettes towards One’s Parents according to Qur’an 17:23–24.

Qur’an 17:23–24 clearly outlines the **etiquettes toward parents**, emphasizing respect, kindness, and mercy. Allah commands:

وَقَضَىٰ رَبُّكَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَانًا

“Worship none but Him, and be dutiful to your parents.” (17:23)

A child must never show disrespect to parents. Even saying a small word of annoyance like “uff” is forbidden. Raising one’s voice, arguing harshly, or speaking rudely is against Islamic manners.

Allah further instructs children to **lower the wing of humility** toward parents and speak gently. This means being polite, patient, and caring, especially when parents become old or weak.

Another important etiquette is **making du‘a for parents**. Allah teaches a beautiful supplication:

رَبِّ اَرْحَمُهُمَا كَمَا رَبَّيَّانِي صَغِيرًا

“My Lord! Have mercy on them as they raised me when I was small.”
(17:24)

Islam also commands obedience to parents as long as it does not involve disobedience to Allah. Serving parents, fulfilling their needs, and showing gratitude are acts of worship.

Thus, honoring parents is one of the greatest obligations in Islam and a means of earning Allah’s pleasure and Paradise.

Q4. Describe the Steps to Purify One’s Soul and Make It Wholesome with Qur’anic References.

Islam places great emphasis on **purifying the soul (Tazkiyat an-Nafs)**. Allah says:

قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا

“Indeed, he succeeds who purifies his soul.” (Qur’an 91:9)

The **first step** is **sincere repentance (Tawbah)**—feeling regret for sins, stopping them, and resolving not to return. Allah promises forgiveness to those who repent sincerely (Qur'an 66:8).

The **second step** is **self-watchfulness (Muraqabah)**—being aware that Allah sees everything.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلَيْكُمْ رَقِيبًا

“Surely Allah is Ever an All-Watcher over you.” (Qur'an 4:1)

The **third step** is **self-accountability (Muhasabah)**—regularly reviewing one's actions and correcting mistakes. Allah says:

وَلْتَنْظُرْ نَفْسٌ مَّا قَدَّمَتْ لِإِعْدٍ

“Let every soul look to what it has sent forth for tomorrow.” (Qur'an 59:18)

The **fourth step** is **struggling against the soul (Mujahadah)**. The human soul naturally inclines toward evil (Qur'an 12:53), so discipline and patience are required.

By following these steps, a believer cleanses the heart, strengthens Eeman, and becomes closer to Allah.